

Joel Stephen

Full-Stack & AI Product Engineer

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Production software across LLM integrations, real-time collaborative canvases, node-graph editors, and Python services. Five-plus years, currently on Opus, an enterprise AI workflow platform used by insurance, chemical, and government customers.

EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack & AI Product Engineer

AppliedAI · Abu Dhabi, UAE

2025-06 - present

I lead engineering on Process Discovery, a real-time collaborative canvas for building AI-agent workflows, in production with clients in insurance, chemicals, and government. Built on Yjs, now a custom conflict-resolution engine to handle scale.

- I forked an open-source workflow engine and rewrote it into Opus's workflow-builder canvas: a node-graph editor with an expressions engine, in TypeScript and Vue.
- I ship features on the customer-facing surface in Next.js, React, and Zustand.
- I build situation-based AI pipelines across multiple LLM providers and integrate ElevenLabs text-to-speech.
- I partner with presales and customer success on technical calls with prospective and existing customers.
- I coach the frontend team on AI tooling and mentor junior and mid-level engineers.

Senior Software Engineer

Otani Trading FZCO · Dubai, UAE

2024-07 - 2025-02

I led project direction and frontend delivery on Flower Meister, a progressive web app for florists, and owned requirements, planning, and DevOps.

- I owned requirements, planning, hosting, CI/CD, monitoring, and Docker for Flower Meister.
- I designed the UI and UX in Figma with shadcn before writing frontend code.
- I built the frontend on Vue 3 with a URQL GraphQL client against a Strawberry and Python backend.
- I trained YOLO v5 models and used OpenCV for detection and tracking in the product's computer-vision features.
- I mentored junior engineers.

Software Engineer

Otani Trading FZCO · Dubai, UAE

2023-09 - 2024-07

I embedded with vendor, merchant, and admin user groups on FMI, a large B2B platform, and shipped seven major features.

- I shipped seven major features across the vendor, merchant, and admin surfaces of FMI.
- I built backend services with FastAPI, Pydantic, and Peewee.
- I built a GraphQL layer with Strawberry over DynamoDB on Project Valit.
- I built frontend UI in Vue with RadixVue and shadcn.

Junior Software Engineer

RIOT by Preowned Collective Portal FZ LLC · Dubai, UAE

2019-09 - 2023-02

I led cross-functional features on a customer-facing platform.

- I integrated three payment gateways and several third-party services into the platform.
- I migrated data from a legacy platform to Node.js and React.

Software Development Engineer Intern

Alucor Limited · Dubai, UAE

2019-01 - 2019-07

I designed and shipped a Django app that replaced an Excel-based workflow.

- I designed and shipped a Django app that replaced an Excel-based workflow, with REST APIs and LDAP authentication.

PROJECTS

Cursor for Product Managers — YC X26 top 10%

I pitched Cursor for Product Managers, a full-stack agentic product for PMs, to the Y Combinator X26 batch and reached the top 10% of applications.

ScamShield

On-device scam and phishing detection for Chrome, Edge, and Brave.

- 903 unit and 138 end-to-end tests
- Benchmark 2026-09-07: 56% of fresh phishing pages blocked before load, 69% stopped, 0 hard false positives on 86 controls

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, Hons.

BITS Pilani, Dubai Campus · Dubai, UAE · 2015–2019

Capstone: TensorFlow and Python stock-price prediction, from data to model to operational signal.

Certifications: AWS Cloud Practitioner (in progress); sixteen further certifications listed on LinkedIn.

SKILLS

AI: Anthropic API, OpenAI API, situation-based pipelines, RAG, ElevenLabs TTS, on-device ML

Real-Time: Yjs/CRDT, custom conflict resolution, WebSocket, SSE, presence, versioning

Interfaces: node-graph editors, canvas rendering, expression engines, undo/redo, virtualised lists, large-graph performance

Product: React, Next.js, Vue, Nuxt, TypeScript, Zustand, Figma-to-production, PWA

Python: FastAPI, Django, Pydantic, Strawberry GraphQL, Peewee, DynamoDB, Postgres, Pytest

Computer Vision: YOLO v5, OpenCV, TensorFlow